

Balaji Sekar

Cybersecurity Leader | SOC Transformation Specialist | Security Operations Architect

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Cybersecurity Leader with 10+ years of experience in Security Operations, SOC Transformation, SIEM Engineering, Incident Response, Threat Hunting, and Security Automation across Banking, Healthcare, and Enterprise environments. Proven expertise in building and transforming Security Operations Centers (SOC), leading global security operations, managing stakeholders, and delivering scalable security capabilities aligned with business objectives.



Websites, Portfolios, Profiles

- <https://balajisekar-cybersec.github.io/portfolio/>
- [linkedin.com/in/balaji-sekar-6a9042179](https://www.linkedin.com/in/balaji-sekar-6a9042179)



Core Competencies

- ◆ SOC Leadership & Transformation
- ◆ Security Operations Management
- ◆ Incident Response & Crisis Management
- ◆ Detection Engineering & Threat Hunting
- ◆ Security Administration & Integrations
- ◆ Stakeholder Management



Professional Experience

Dec 2025 - Senior Security Engineer

Current

NextGen Healthcare, Remote

- Leading the design, implementation, and operationalization of an enterprise in-house Security Operations Center (SOC) capability from the ground up.
- Driving SOC strategy, governance, and operating model development aligned with business and security objectives.
- Designing security monitoring architecture, detection engineering strategy, and incident response workflows.

- Establishing enterprise-wide security visibility through integration of critical log sources, security tools, and automation capabilities.
- Developing and implementing security use cases, response playbooks, escalation procedures, and operational standards.
- Collaborating with executive leadership, infrastructure, cloud, and application teams to strengthen organizational security posture.
- Providing strategic recommendations for SOC maturity enhancement, operational efficiency, and continuous security improvement.
- Leading security investigations, incident response activities, and proactive threat detection initiatives.

Major Achievement:

Successfully establishing a fully functional in-house Security Operations Center including people, process, technology, integrations, and operational framework.

Dec 2024 - Dec 2025 Senior Information Technology Security Consultant

IBM Switzerland, Zurich, Switzerland

- Led enterprise SOC operations for a major Swiss banking customer within a highly regulated environment.
- Served as technical lead for security operations, major incident response, and escalations.
- Managed stakeholder communication, security governance discussions, and operational reviews.
- Enhanced security monitoring and detection capabilities through SIEM optimization and automation initiatives.
- Mentored analysts and drove operational excellence initiatives across the SOC.

Apr 2019 - Dec 2024 Senior Security Consultant / Incident Response

IBM India, Bengaluru, India

- Led end-to-end incident response, threat hunting, and enterprise SOC operations for global customers.
- Successfully established and operationalized SOC capabilities and Vulnerability Management for a multinational cosmetics organization from inception to steady-state operations.
- Developed and implemented security use cases, detection rules, and response procedures.
- Managed critical security incidents, digital forensic investigations, and threat intelligence activities.
- Delivered security transformation initiatives and continuously improved SOC processes and operational maturity.

Jun 2016 - Apr 2019 Security Analyst

Wipro, Bengaluru, India

- Performed security monitoring, incident triage, and SOC operations.
- Mentored analysts and drove continuous improvements in security operations.



Key Achievements

- Built and transformed Security Operations Centers for multiple global organizations.
- Established enterprise SOC capabilities from the ground up for healthcare and multinational organizations.
- Managed security operations for banking, healthcare, and enterprise customers across multiple geographies.
- Recipient of IBM Eminence in Delivery Awards (H1 2024 and H2 2022) for exceptional delivery excellence.
- International experience leading security operations engagements in Switzerland.
- Recognized for driving security transformation, operational excellence, and SOC maturity initiatives.



Tools and Technologies

Security Information & Event Management (SIEM) • IBM QRadar • Microsoft Sentinel • RSA NetWitness • SIEM Architecture & Use Case Engineering
Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR/XDR) • Palo Alto Cortex XDR • Microsoft Defender for Endpoint • Cybereason • Endpoint Security Operations
Incident Response & Threat Hunting • Incident Response & Crisis Management • Threat Hunting • Threat Intelligence • Digital Forensics • Malware Analysis • Detection Engineering • MITRE ATT&CK Framework
Network Security & Traffic Analysis • Wireshark • Flowmon • Arbor Networks • McAfee NSM
Email & Messaging Security • Proofpoint • Cisco Cloud Security (CSM) • Cisco IronPort
Malware Analysis & Sandboxing • FireEye Malware Analysis System (MAS) • Cuckoo Sandbox
Cloud Security • Microsoft Azure • Microsoft Defender • Azure Sentinel
ITSM & Security Operations • ServiceNow • HP ITSM • Serena
Vulnerability management
Tenable Nessus



Education

Apr 2016 Master of Science: Software Engineering
Sri Krishna College of Enginerring And Technology - Coimbatore, India



Certifications

CEH

CompTIA CySA+

Microsoft SC-200, SC-900